

Ayub Khan Era (1958–1969)

Pakistan's Historical Trajectory

Background of Ayub Khan Era (1958–1969)

- Military coup of 1958 ended parliamentary democracy
- Ayub Khan became first military ruler of Pakistan
- Abrogation of 1956 Constitution and imposition of Martial Law
- Aim: political stability, economic growth, and controlled democracy

Introduction of Basic Democracies System

- Introduced in 1959 as a four-tier local government system
- Consisted of Union, Tehsil, District, and Divisional councils
- Basic Democrats elected by people but tightly controlled by regime
- Used as an electoral college for presidential elections

1962 Constitution of Pakistan

- Promulgated without public referendum
- Introduced presidential form of government
- Strong executive powers vested in President
- Limited role of judiciary and no adult franchise initially

Political Impact of Ayub Era

- Centralization of power weakened democratic institutions
- Political parties were initially banned
- Opposition movements suppressed
- Growing resentment in East Pakistan

Decade of Development – Economic Policies

- 1960s declared as 'Decade of Development'
- Focus on industrialization and private sector growth
- Introduction of Green Revolution in agriculture
- Rapid urban and infrastructural development

Economic Achievements

- High GDP growth rate (around 6%)
- Development of large-scale industries
- Expansion of banking and financial institutions
- Improved irrigation and agricultural output

Economic Inequalities and Criticism

- Wealth concentrated among 22 industrial families
- Economic disparity between East and West Pakistan
- Neglect of social justice and labor rights
- Rising public dissatisfaction

End of Ayub Khan Era

- Mass protests and political unrest (1968–69)
- Agartala Conspiracy Case intensified tensions
- Resigned in March 1969
- Power transferred to General Yahya Khan